landmark

Constitution

Article 1 | Name

This organization shall be called the Landmark Association, and will hold membership in the General Association of General Baptist.

Article 2 | Purpose

This association will partner together for the purpose of leadership development and to plant new churches.

Article 3 | Statements of Faith

The Statements of Faith for this association shall be the Statements of Faith of the General Association of General Baptists.

Article 4 | Membership

Membership in this association shall be comprised of local General Baptist and mission churches, and distant General Baptist and mission churches (under special provisions). Member churches in this association voluntarily enter into a cooperative relationship to fulfill the purposes of the association, to adhere to the doctrine of this Constitution, and to financially support the association.

Section 1. Local Church Membership

Local General Baptist churches and mission churches are those within The Ozarks as defined by the United States Geological Survey (see Appendix 1).

Section 2. Distant Church Membership

Distant General Baptist churches and mission churches are those outside of The Ozarks who will commit to attend the annual meetings and leadership development events.

Article 5 l Government

The government of this association is vested in the Council of Representatives, comprised of two representatives from each member church, and is administered by the officers of the association. In function, final authority shall reside in the Council of Representatives.

Article 6 l Officers

The officers of this association shall be the President, Vice President, Administrator, and Council of Association Representatives.

Article 7 l Assets Holdings and Distribution

Section 1. Giving

Member churches are encouraged to give directly to the association a set percentage of their discretion. Sponsored church plants would be determined at the annual meeting.

Section 2. Operational Cost

Any operational cost will be covered by a budget determined at the annual meeting.

Section 3. Property & Material Assets

This association will not receive property or material assets. The association will encourage the donor to give directly to a church plant, associational church or the National Mission Department of the Association of General Baptist.

Article 8 l Amendments

This constitution may be amended at an annual meeting when a proposed amendment has been presented to the member churches in writing at least two months prior to the annual meeting in which the amendment will be presented. A two-thirds majority vote of the representatives at the meeting is required for passage.

By-Laws

Article 1 I Membership

Section 1. Application Process

Any church or mission church desiring to affiliate with this association may do so by submitting a request for membership to the associational Administrator 60 days prior to the associations annual meeting. These request should include; a letter requesting acceptance into this association, a brief history of the church's or mission church's inception, organization, and existing ministries. The Administrator shall forward the request to each member church 45 days prior to the annual meeting. At the annual meeting the association representatives will vote to accept or decline the applicant. Acceptance into this association will require an unanimous decision by the churches represented. If an applicant church is accepted and is a member of an existing local association, the applicant will not receive full membership status until the applicant church sends a copy of a dissolution request to the previous local association and to the association Administrator.

Section 2. Rights and Responsibilities

1. Voting privileges are extended only to the representatives of the member churches that are active in associational events and activities. Churches not represented at two consecutive annual meetings will be considered inactive and therefore be ineligible to vote in the following annual meeting.

2. No proxy votes will be allowed.

3. It shall be the duty of member churches to uphold and do no harm to the associational Statements of Faith, Constitution, or By-Laws.

4. Member churches have a responsibility to Christ and His Kingdom to give financially to the association to aide in funding the associational church plants, conferences and operational cost.

5. It shall be the responsibility of each member church to accurately report the Church Growth Report to the associational Administrator by January 31st. For reporting purposes, membership on the Church Growth Report will be based off weekend attendance.

Section 3. Termination of Membership

1. Membership may be terminated by request of the participating church for any reason. Membership may also be terminated by the association; for those who have become uncooperative in their conduct, have refused reformation and/or

reconciliation with the association; and for those who have not attended two successive annual meetings whose reason is not allowed by the association's President.

2. Churches desiring reinstatement into associational membership shall provide a written request for such to the associational Administrator 60 days before the annual meeting. The written request shall include a thorough explanation of how the causes of termination have been corrected. The Administrator shall forward the request to each member church 45 days prior to the annual meeting. At the annual meeting the association representatives will vote to reinstate or decline the applicant. Reinstatement into this association will require an unanimous decision by the churches represented.

Article 2 I Meetings

Section 1. Annual Meeting

The Annual Meeting of the association shall be held in October each year. Registered representatives shall constitute the voting body for the transaction of business. Two-thirds of the associational churches must be present to constitute a quorum.

Section 2. Leadership Development Events

1. Leadership Roundtable

The association shall informally gather at the General Association of General Baptist Mission and Ministry Summit to learn, network and fellowship.

2. Developing Leaders Conference

The association shall informally gather in March of each year to train ministers and lay ministers in leadership and methodology principles.

Section 3. Ordination Services

Ordination Services shall be held at the church of the candidate being ordained. The dates and times will be determined by the host church and the ordination candidate once ordination is approved by the host church. It is strongly encouraged for the member churches to send representation and support to all ordination services.

This association will leave ordaining pastors, elders and deacons; and the standard by which they are ordained to the member church which they serve however those who are called to an office in the church are to live a life in

obedience to Scripture and to live either in fidelity within the covenant of marriage between a man and a woman, or chastity in singleness.

Article 3 I Councils

Section 1. Council of Representatives

The Council of Representatives shall be comprised of two representatives from each member church, along with one designated alternate, and will be the governing body of the association. The Council of Representatives shall; elect officers of the association, determine the associational church plants, admit or deny applicants into the association, and to amend the constitution and by-laws.

Section 2. Ad Hoc Councils

The Council of Representatives shall have the authority to establish Ad Hoc Councils for specific purposes that shall report to the Council of Representatives. All Ad Hoc Councils will be dissolved once the purpose for commissioning has been resolved.

Article 4 I Officers of the Association

Section 1. President

The President of the association shall be a Council of Representatives member who is elected by the Council to serve as a chairman of the annual meeting and to organize the Leadership Development Events. The President shall set the dates, times, and locations for all associational meetings. The President shall be elected to a 3 year term, with reoccurring terms possible.

Section 2. Vice President

The Vice President of the association shall be a Council of Representative member who is elected by the Council to serve as a vice chairman of the annual meeting and to assist in organizing the Leadership Development Events. The Vice President shall serve in the absence of the President in any formal or informal associational event. The Vice President shall be elected to a 3 year term, with reoccurring terms possible.

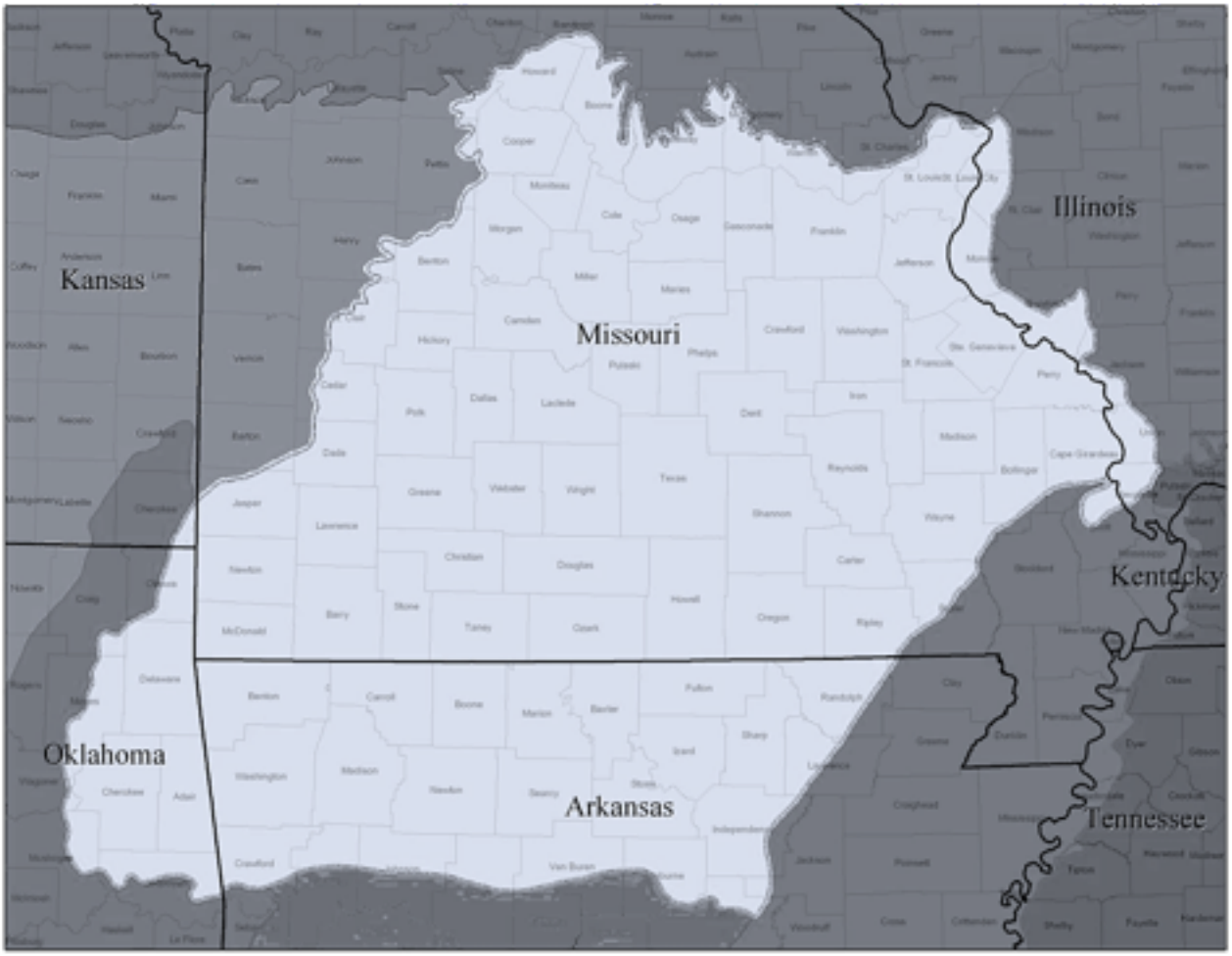
Section 3. Administrator

The association Administrator shall be a member of an association church who is elected by the Council of Representative to serve as a clerk, secretary, and reporter for the association at formal and informal associational events as well as fulfill those roles throughout the year. The Administrator shall be elected to a 3 year term, with reoccurring terms possible.

Section 4. Council of Associations Representatives

The Council of Associations Representatives shall be a member of an association church who is elected by the Council of Representative to serve as representatives to the General Association of General Baptist Council of Associations. The association will send one Council of Associations Representative for every 1000 weekend worship attenders based off the yearly weekend attendance recorded on the Church Growth Report. Council of Associations Representatives shall be elected to a 3 year term, with reoccurring terms possible.

Article 5 I Amendments

Any by-law may be amended at an annual meeting when a proposed amendment has been presented to the member churches or mission churches in writing at least two months prior to the annual meeting in which the amendment will be presented. A two-thirds majority vote of the representatives at the meeting is required for passage.

Appendix 1 I The Ozarks Classification Map